



Also Remember...

- To buy a UPS all you need to do is add up the total power draw of your equipment.
- First, decide which pieces of equipment need UPS support. Typically, only the CPU and monitor are supported to cut down on power draw to the UPS.
- If the power draw is expressed in Amps then multiply that value by your nominal line voltage, 230V. If the power draw is expressed in Watts, multiply by a factor of 1.3 to 1.4 for VA load.
- Example: 250 Watt power supply (x 1.4) = 350 VA load (assuming that your monitor is drawing power from the power supply of the PC). Add a measure of safety and 500 VA is enough for most PCs.

Power tips for UPS

- Before cleaning the UPS, make sure the power is completely switched off. Then unplug all the attached peripherals and clean the UPS with a dry soft cloth.
- It is advisable to completely charge and

discharge the battery of the UPS once a month to prolong the battery life. To do this, run the computer from the battery itself so that it is completely discharged, and then recharge it.

Future Of The UPS



UPS systems have come a long way from being just batteries connected to small circuits in a box. Today's UPS systems, especially those catering to the enterprise segment, have control and power management features that would put some of the geekiest equipment to shame.

With time, UPSes have evolved from being simple, relay—controlled switching behemoths to DSP—based compact systems. The search is still on for the perfect UPS, which will have features like optimum redundancy, highest MTBF (mean time between failures), lowest MTTR (mean time to repair), best power control features, better remote management features and so on.

One of the biggest boons to the enterprise has been the introduction of centralised UPS systems. Earlier, the power-conditioning infrastructure depended mainly on distributed UPSes for smooth, clean power flow. In centralised UPS solutions, a single UPS is used to feed a dedicated ring main, which supports several critical load items. Although it's an expensive solution, such centralised UPS systems are more versatile and cost-effective in terms of load utilisation and battery capacity. They're easier to maintain, upgrade and manage than distributed UPSes. The price per KVA also comes down with such systems. It's much easier to configure the power conditioning system in case new additions have to be made to the network.

The next trend in the Indian UPS industry would be a major shift towards reliability, man-

ageability and intelligent products. UPSes are as important for mission-critical applications as any other element, and reliability is a major issue. At the same time, intelligent products will be able to maximise power availability for the equipment that needs it most, shutting down non-necessary equipment at different stages of battery usage. Running costs will also be a driving factor.

Terms such as Reliability, Redundancy, Intelligence and Remote Manageability are new buzzwords of the power conditioning industry. Without a doubt, UPSes will very soon be synonymous with power conditioning, as other solutions simply cannot compare with the power that a UPS can offer you.

As UPSes grow in popularity, expect to see a shift towards top-of-the-line online UPSes. This shift will be made possible by falling costs, as technology becomes cheaper and more accessible. Online UPSes feature more interactivity and scalability, not to mention greater standby time. Considering the direction the power conditioning industry is headed, and observing the technologies being developed to enhance reliability and efficiency, we'll certainly hear more about these devices soon.

UPSes are gaining increasing visibility among home users as they realise the importance of securing their expensive electronic equipment from the vagaries of Indian power companies. It won't be too long before we see a UPS in every home.

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Stellar Information Systems Ltd.

(A-101 R&D Company)

Corporate Office
304 Deepak Building, 92 Nehru Place
Data Recovery Lab
205, Skipper Corner, 88 Nehru Place
New Delhi - 10
Voice : 91-11-26418809, 26418810,
26282262, 26440806, 2648810

www.stellarinfo.com

Bangalore
Voice : 91 80 6327866, 6327866
Mobile :
Voice : 91-22-28215946, 28215947
recovery@stellarinfo.com
sales@stellarinfo.com